

[Lesson 31](#): “Sealed ... for Time and for All Eternity” (See L31 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us understand that eternal marriage is an essential part of Heavenly Father’s plan, to help youth prepare for eternal marriage, and to encourage married couples to abide in the marriage covenant.

1. Eternal marriage is essential in Heavenly Father’s plan.

• D&C 131:1-4; 132:4-33. A “man must enter into ... the new and everlasting covenant of marriage”.

†1. Elder Parley P. Pratt

“The First Presidency and Quorum of the Twelve Apostles have declared that ‘marriage between man and woman is essential to [God’s] eternal plan’ (‘[The Family: A Proclamation to the World](#),’ *Ensign*, Nov. 1995, 102; see also [D&C 49:15](#)). (*Lesson Manual*)

Why is marriage an essential part of God’s eternal plan? (See [1 Corinthians 11:11](#).)

†2. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin †3. President Boyd K. Packer †4. President Joseph Fielding Smith

• D&C 132:7, 15-18. If we marry “not by my word ... their covenant and marriage is not of force when they are dead”.

What blessings will we receive by entering and keeping the “new and everlasting covenant of marriage”?

- D&C 132:19 To be together “in time, and through all eternity”.
- D&C 131:103; 132:23-24 To be exalted in the highest degree of the celestial kingdom.
- D&C 132:19 To “inherit thrones, kingdoms, principalities, ... power, [and] dominions”.
- D&C 132:19, 30-31; 131:4 To have seed, or spirit children, throughout eternity.
- D&C 132:20-21 To “be gods, because they have all power”.

What blessings does temple marriage bring in mortality?

2. Youth should prepare now for eternal marriage.

Why do you think temple marriage is emphasized so much to the youth of the Church?

†5. President Spencer W. Kimball

How does dating during teenage years influence marriage later in life? (*For the Strength of Youth*, “[Dating](#)”) For the youth:

What kind of person do you want to marry someday?

How must you live to prepare to marry such a person?

†6. President Gordon B. Hinckley †7. Elder Richard G. Scott

How can we help our youth desire and prepare for temple marriage?

3. After a husband and wife are sealed in the temple, they must abide in the covenant to receive the promised blessings.

Who said this? †8. Mystery Quotation

• D&C 42:22. What does it mean to love a husband or wife with all one’s heart?

What does it mean to cleave to a husband or wife and none else? †9. President Spencer W. Kimball

†10. Elder Russell M. Nelson †11. President Gordon B. Hinckley

“When a man and woman are married in the temple, they covenant to be true to one another and to be true to the Lord.” (*Lesson Manual*)

What are some things that married couples can do to strengthen their love for each other and for the Lord?

Comfort for single brothers and sisters: †12. Elder Dallin H. Oaks †13. Elder Richard G. Scott

Next Week: L32: “To Seal the Testimony”; See L32 [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).) † •

†1. **Elder Parley P. Pratt:** “I had loved before, but I knew not why. But now I loved—with a pureness—an intensity of elevated, exalted feeling, which would lift my soul. ... I felt that God was my heavenly Father indeed; that Jesus was my brother, and that the wife of my bosom was an immortal, eternal companion. ... In short, I could now love with the spirit and with the understanding also” (*Autobiography of Parley P. Pratt* [1975], 298).

†2. **Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin:** “The sweet companionship of eternal marriage is one of the greatest blessings God has granted to His children. Certainly, the many years I have shared with my beautiful companion have brought me the deepest joys of my life. From the beginning of time, marital companionship of husband and wife has been fundamental to our Heavenly Father’s great plan of happiness. Our lives are touched for good, and we are both edified and ennobled as we savor the sweet blessings of association with dear members of the family” (“[Valued Companions](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1997, 32).

†3. **President Boyd K. Packer:** “The ultimate purpose of all we teach is to unite parents and children in faith in the Lord Jesus Christ, that they are happy at home, sealed in an eternal marriage, linked to their generations, and assured of exaltation in the presence of our Heavenly Father” (“[The Shield of Faith](#),” *Ensign*, May 1995, 8).

†4. **President Joseph Fielding Smith:** “Marriage, as understood by Latter-day Saints, is a covenant ordained to be everlasting. It is the foundation for eternal exaltation, for without it there could be no eternal progress in the kingdom of God” (*Doctrines of Salvation*, comp. Bruce R. McConkie, 3 vols. [1954–56], 2:58).

†5. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “Marriage is perhaps the most vital of all ... decisions and has the most far-reaching effects, for it has to do not only with immediate happiness, but also with eternal joys. It affects not only the two people involved, but also their families and particularly their children and their children’s children down through the many generations” (“[Oneness in Marriage](#),” *Ensign*, Mar. 1977, 3).

†6. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** “Choose a companion of your own faith. You are much more likely to be happy. Choose a companion you can

always honor, you can always respect, one who will complement you in your own life, one to whom you can give your entire heart, your entire love, your entire allegiance, your entire loyalty” (“[Life’s Obligations](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 1999, 2).

†7. **Elder Richard G. Scott:** “There is more to a foundation of eternal marriage than a pretty face or an attractive figure. There is more to consider than popularity or charisma. As you seek an eternal companion, look for someone who is developing the essential attributes that bring happiness: a deep love of the Lord and of His commandments, a determination to live them, one that is kindly understanding, forgiving of others, and willing to give of self, with the desire to have a family crowned with beautiful children and a commitment to teach them the principles of truth in the home.

“An essential priority of a prospective wife is the desire to be a wife and mother. She should be developing the sacred qualities that God has given His daughters to excel as a wife and mother: patience, kindness, a love of children, and a desire to care for them rather than seeking professional pursuits. She should be acquiring a good education to prepare for the demands of motherhood.

“A prospective husband should also honor his priesthood and use it in service to others. Seek a man who accepts his role as provider of the necessities of life, has the capacity to do it, and is making concerted efforts to prepare himself to fulfill those responsibilities” (“[Receive the Temple Blessings](#),” *Ensign*, May 1999, 26).

Recommended Reading:

1. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin, “[Valued Companions](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1997, 32.
2. President Spencer W. Kimball, “[Oneness in Marriage](#),” *Ensign*, Mar. 1977, 3.
3. Elder Richard G. Scott, “[Receive the Temple Blessings](#),” *Ensign*, May 1999, 26.
4. Elder Russell M. Nelson, “[Nurturing Marriage](#),” *Ensign*, May 2006.
5. Elder L. Whitney Clayton, “[Marriage: Watch and Learn](#),” *Ensign*, May 2013.
6. Elizabeth Vendenberghe, “[Happiness, Health, and Marriage](#),” *Ensign*, August 2001.
7. “[Good things come to couples who wait](#),” BYU Study.

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†8. **Mystery Quotation:** “I was just sure the first ten years would be bliss. But during our first year together I discovered ... there were a lot of adjustments. Of course, they weren’t the kind of thing you ran home to mother about. **But I cried into my pillow now and again.** The problems were almost always related to learning to live on someone else’s schedule and to do things someone else’s way. We loved each other, there was no doubt about that. But we also had to get used to each other. I think every couple has to get used to each other.” (See Sheri L. Dew, *Go Forward with Faith: The Biography of Gordon B. Hinckley* [1966], 118). (The answer is Sister Marjorie P. Hinckley.)

†9. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “When the Lord says all thy heart, it allows for no sharing nor dividing nor depriving. ...

“The words none else eliminate everyone and everything. The spouse then becomes preeminent in the life of the husband or wife, and neither social life nor occupational life nor political life nor any other interest nor person nor thing shall ever take precedence over the companion spouse. ...

“Marriage presupposes total allegiance and total fidelity. Each spouse takes the partner with the understanding that he or she gives totally to the spouse all the heart, strength, loyalty, honor, and affection, with all dignity. Any divergence is sin; any sharing of the heart is transgression. As we should have ‘an eye single to the glory of God,’ so should we have an eye, an ear, a heart single to the marriage and the spouse and family” (*Faith Precedes the Miracle* [1972], 142–43).

†10. **Elder Russell M. Nelson:** “As we Brethren travel about the world, sometimes we see worrisome scenes. On a recent flight, I sat behind a husband and wife. She obviously loved her husband. As she stroked the back of his neck I could see her wedding ring. She would nestle close to him and rest her head upon his shoulder, seeking his companionship.

“In contrast, he seemed totally oblivious to her presence. He was focused solely upon an electronic game player. During the entire flight, his attention was riveted upon that device. Not once did he look at her, speak to her, or acknowledge her yearning for affection. ...

“I don’t know more about them. I haven’t seen them since. ...

“But these things I do know: I know “that marriage between a man and a woman is ordained of God and that the family is central to the Creator’s plan for the eternal destiny of His children. I know that the earth was created and that the Lord’s Church was restored so that families could be sealed and exalted as eternal entities. And I know that one of Satan’s cunning

methods of undermining the work of the Lord is to attack the sacred institutions of marriage and the family.” (“[Nurturing Marriage](#),” *Ensign*, May, 2006)

†11. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** “Be fiercely loyal one to another” (“[Life’s Obligations](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 1999, 4).

†12. **Elder Dallin H. Oaks:** “We know that many worthy and wonderful Latter-day Saints currently lack the ideal opportunities and essential requirements for their progress. Singleness, childlessness, death, and divorce frustrate ideals and postpone the fulfillment of promised blessings. In addition, some women who desire to be full-time mothers and homemakers have been literally compelled to enter the full-time workforce. But these frustrations are only temporary. The Lord has promised that in the eternities no blessing will be denied his sons and daughters who keep the commandments, are true to their covenants, and desire what is right.

“Many of the most important deprivations of mortality will be set right in the Millennium, which is the time for fulfilling all that is incomplete in the great plan of happiness for all of our Father’s worthy children. We know that will be true of temple ordinances. I believe it will also be true of family relationships and experiences” (“[The Great Plan of Happiness](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1993, 75).

†13. **Elder Richard G. Scott:** “If you are single and haven’t identified a solid prospect for celestial marriage, live for it. Pray for it. Expect it in the timetable of the Lord. Do not compromise your standards in any way that would rule out that blessing on this or the other side of the veil. The Lord knows the intent of your heart. His prophets have stated that you will have that blessing as you consistently live to qualify for it. We do not know whether it will be on this or the other side of the veil. But live for it. Pray for it” (“[Receive the Temple Blessings](#),” *Ensign*, May 1999, 27).

Recommended Media and further Reading:

1. Pictures of [Temples](#).
2. Video of [President Howard W. Hunter](#) (1:22).
3. Video of [Elder David A. Bednar](#) (:53).
4. Video of [Elder Russell M. Nelson](#) (2:17).
5. Video of “[The Sealing Power](#)” (3:37).

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